

Thomas Butman

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SUMMARY

Ten years shipping payment software for fintech startups, most of it as the engineer who owned the whole frontend. Today I work across the stack, from data model to deploy, and use AI agents to cover the ground of a small team. Open to remote US or on-site Lisbon roles, full-time or contract, in any US time zone.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance · Software Engineer

Remote · 2025 - Now

- Built an ACH payment flow that collects recipient bank and address details, as composable, embeddable React components that can be extended to new payment networks.
- Added single sign-on with social and enterprise identity providers alongside the existing password login.

React · Okta/Auth0 · Google Places API · Storybook

DigitalPay · Senior Software Engineer

San Francisco, CA · 2019 - 2025

- Owned frontend development for all core applications: customer-facing payment products, internal tools and sales demos, used by millions of recipients and processing hundreds of millions of dollars in payments.
- Remained the sole frontend engineer as the team shrank from 22 people to 6, maintaining every application and shipping all new features.
- Shipped payout experiences that let recipients choose from more than 250 payment options, including direct-to-bank, digital debit card, wallet balance and gift cards.
- Built a shared component library used across company applications, with per-customer theming.

React · AWS · Storybook · Webpack

Sipree · Software Engineer

San Francisco, CA · 2016 - 2019

- Led development of the recipient portal, a payment flow whose layout, networks and steps are driven by JSON config from a REST API.
- Built an admin console for managing program configuration, users, roles and cash-flow reporting across environments.
- Worked directly with the sales team to build configurable product demos, including image recognition with AWS Rekognition and Lambda.

React · Redux · AWS Lambda · API Gateway · Material-UI

Allergan · Study Management Associate

Irvine, CA · 2007 - 2015

- Automated bulk document imports with scripting, raising throughput from about 100 documents a day to 2,300.
- Bridged technical and clinical teams across the US, UK, Australia and Japan.
- Completed a BA and computer science coursework (4.0 GPA) while working full time.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- PepAlert** (pepalert.com) · A live price-comparison product that tracks pricing, stock and lab reports across hundreds of vendor channels, with alerts, an order optimizer and chat bots. Next.js · TypeScript · SQLite · Drizzle · Claude API · Stripe
- Chatlingo** · Upload a WhatsApp export and read it in your language, with voice notes transcribed and translated in place. React · Express · Postgres · Whisper · Drizzle
- Smart Shopping** · A barcode-driven household shopping system: one authoritative backend, offline-first device clients and a full hardware simulator. TypeScript · Fastify · SQLite · React · Playwright
- Spot-Watch** · An ESP32 parking camera with a mobile dashboard, signed over-the-air updates and HTTPS end to end. C++ · ESP32-S3 · Embedded web UI · OTA

SKILLS

Frontend: TypeScript, React, Next.js, Redux, Tailwind CSS, Storybook, Vite, Webpack, accessibility
Backend: Node.js, Express, Fastify, REST APIs, Python/Flask, OAuth and SSO
Data: PostgreSQL, SQLite, Drizzle ORM, DynamoDB, MongoDB
Infrastructure and testing: AWS (Lambda, S3, API Gateway), Docker, CI, Vitest, Playwright, Mocha
AI: Claude Code, Codex, Anthropic and OpenAI APIs, Whisper
Embedded: C++, ESP32, Arduino, OTA updates

EDUCATION

- MakerSquare** · Software engineering immersive · 2015 – **Irvine Valley College** · Computer science, 4.0 GPA · 2014
- National University** · BA, Interdisciplinary Studies · 2012